



COMPETENCY STANDARD

FOR

IT FREELANCING

(ICT SECTOR)

Skills for Industry Competitiveness and Innovation Program (SICIP)
Finance Division, Ministry of Finance

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The Competency Standards for IT Freelancing serve as a foundational document for the development of curricula, teaching materials, and assessment tools specifically tailored for the ICT sector. This document ensures that training activities align with industry requirements, enabling individuals who successfully meet the established standards through assessment to become qualified professionals in relevant roles within the sector.

Developed under the Skills for Industry Competitiveness and Innovation Program (SICIP), this document addresses the skills requirements critical for IT Freelancing. It is owned by the Finance Division of the Ministry of Finance of the People's Republic of Bangladesh.

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INTRODUCTION

The Skills for Industry Competitiveness and Innovation Program (SICIP) has the overall objective of developing a skilled workforce adept at handling new technologies, especially for emerging industries in Bangladesh. It will expand skills training and strengthen the development of the training ecosystem to address the skills requirements of the SICIP-selected industry sectors. The program aims to (i) increase the technology-oriented skilled workforce across emerging and priority sectors, (ii) promote inclusive skilling and upskilling opportunities for women and socially disadvantaged groups, (iii) incentivize industry-university partnerships to nurture innovation capacity and improve industry competitiveness, and (iv) foster skills for climate-resilient manufacturing processes and green technologies. The program is expected to benefit about 220,000 new and existing workers over a 6-year implementation period from 2024-2029.

The SICIP Program has, therefore, taken the initiative to enhance the employability and productivity of trainees by implementing market-responsive and job-focused training programs through public and private training providers. This will require the development of competency standards for each of the occupations/trades which will provide a structured framework in the learning process to guide training providers, ensure consistent training quality, and create an alignment between the skills provided by the training institutes and the needs of the industry.

This competency standard is therefore developed to improve skills following the job roles and skill sets of the occupation and ensure that the required skills are aligned with industry requirements.

The Competency Standard also suggests integration of YouTube or similar digital platforms or downloaded clips into classroom practice to ensure simulated creation of the contents so that learners are exposed to visual demonstrations before classroom instruction or practical session, which aligns with modern learning preference and supports flipped classroom models.

The document details the format, sequencing, wording, and layout of the Competency Standard for an occupation which comprises Units of Competence and its corresponding Elements.

OVERVIEW:

A **Competency Standard** is a written specification of the knowledge, skills, and attitudes required for the performance of a job or occupation or trade corresponding to the standard of performance required in the workplace.

Competency standard:

- provides a consistent and reliable set of components for training, recognizing, and assessing people's skills, and may also have optional support materials.
- enables industry-recognized qualifications to be awarded through direct assessment of workplace competencies
- encourages the development and delivery of flexible training that suits individual and industry requirements
- encourages learning and assessment in a work-related environment which leads to verifiable workplace outcomes.

Competency Standard has been developed by a working group comprised of occupation-specific experts from the industry/institution and relevant consultants of SICIP.

Competency Standards describe the skills, knowledge, and attitude needed to perform effectively in the workplace. Competency Standards acknowledge that people can achieve vocational and technical competency in many ways by emphasizing what the learner can do, not how or where they learned to do it.

With Competency Standards, assessment and training may be conducted at the workplace, at training organization, during regular work, or through work experience, work placement, work simulation or any combination of these.

A Unit of Competency describes a distinct work activity that would normally be undertaken by one person in accordance with industry standards.

Units of Competency are documented in a standard format that comprises:

- Reference to Industry Sector, Occupational Title and Occupational Description
- Unit code
- Unit title
- Unit descriptor
- Unit of Competency
- Elements and performance criteria
- Variables and range statement
- Evidence guides

Together all the parts of a Unit of Competency:

- Describe a work activity
- Guide the assessor in determining whether the candidate is competent.

Identification and validation of units of competency and elements for each occupation were made by experts from various Light Engineering companies in industry consultative workshops.

The ensuing sections of this document comprise a description of the respective occupation with all the key components of a Unit of Competence:

- An overview of all Units of Competence for the occupation and their corresponding duration required for completion of training.
- The Competency Standards that include the Unit of Competency, Unit Descriptor, Elements and Performance Criteria, Range of Variables, Curricular Content Guide, and Assessment Evidence Guide.

Units & Elements at a Glance:

Generic Competencies (20 hrs.)

Code	Unit of Competency	Elements of Competency	Duration (Hours)
SICIP-ICT-ITF-01-G	Apply Occupational Health and Safety (OHS) Practices in the Workplace	1. Identify OHS policies and procedures 2. Apply personal health and safety procedures 3. Report hazards and risks 4. Respond to emergencies	10
SICIP-ICT-ITF-02-G	Carryout Workplace Interaction in English	1. Interpret workplace communication and etiquette 2. Read and understand workplace documents 3. Participate in workplace meetings and discussions 4. Practice professional ethics at workplace	10
Total Hour			20 Hrs.

Sector Specific Competencies (30 hrs.)

Code	Unit of Competency	Elements of Competency	Duration (Hours)
SICIP-ICT-ITF-01-S	Operate Office Application Software	1. Operate computer 2. Install application software 3. Use word processor to prepare/create documents 4. Use spreadsheet to create/prepare worksheets 5. Use presentation software to create/prepare presentation 6. Print a document	30
Total Hour			30 Hrs.

Occupation Specific Competencies (310 hrs.)

Code	Unit of Competency	Elements of Competency	Duration (hours)
SICIP-ICT-ITF-01-O	Apply Basic Knowledge of IT Freelancing	1. Identify concept and scope of IT freelancing. 2. Use different freelancing platforms. 3. Create and maintain a professional portfolio.	20
SICIP-ICT-ITF-02-O	Perform Data Entry	1. Identify types and sources of data entry work. 2. Use common data entry tools and software 3. Carryout accurate and efficient data entry. 4. Review and correct data errors.	40
SICIP-ICT-ITF-03-O	Perform Basic Graphic Design Tasks	1. Identify basic principles of graphic design. 2. Use design tools (Canva or Adobe Photoshop). 3. Create simple designs for social media and web use. 4. Edit and format images.	30
SICIP-ICT-ITF-04-O	Perform Search Engine Optimization (SEO)	1. Identify and interpret SEO concepts. 2. Set up and manage websites for SEO. 3. Apply on-page SEO techniques. 4. Apply off-page SEO techniques. 5. Implement mobile SEO techniques. 6. Measure and report SEO performance.	70
SICIP-ICT-ITF-05-O	Perform Social Media Marketing (SMM)	1. Identify major social media platforms. 2. Create and manage social media pages or profiles. 3. Develop and post engaging content. 4. Run paid and organic marketing campaigns. 5. Analyze social media	60

		performance and insights. 6. Improve strategy based on results and feedback.	
SICIP-ICT-ITF-06-O	Perform Affiliate Marketing	1. Explain the concept and process of affiliate marketing. 2. Identify suitable affiliate programs and products. 3. Create content for affiliate promotion. 4. Carryout affiliate marketing activities. 5. Develop strategies to increase conversion and income.	40
SICIP-ICT-ITF-07-O	Apply AI Tools and Techniques in IT Freelancing	1. Identify commonly used AI tools for freelancers. 2. Use AI tools for writing, design, and data tasks. 3. Generate creative content using AI applications. 4. Ensure ethical and responsible use of AI tools.	20
SICIP-ICT-ITF-08-O	Implement Freelancing Business Activities	1. Apply basic business online practices. 2. Search and bid for jobs on freelancing platforms. 3. Communicate and negotiate with clients. 4. Perform and deliver assigned work. 5. Maintain records of income and client feedback.	30
Total Hour			0 Hrs.

COMPETENCY STANDARD: IT FREELANCING

The Generic Competencies

Unit of Competency: APPLY OCCUPATIONAL HEALTH AND SAFETY (OHS) PRACTICES IN THE WORKPLACE	Nominal Duration: 10 hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-ICT-ITF-01-G
Unit Descriptor: This unit covers knowledge, skills and attitudes required to apply occupational health and safety (OHS) practices in the workplace. It specifically includes the tasks of identifying OHS policies and procedures, applying personal health and safety procedures, reporting hazards and risks, and responding to emergencies.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Identify OHS policies and procedures	1.1 <u>OHS policies</u> and safe operating procedures are read and understood. 1.2 Safety signs and symbols are identified and followed. 1.3 Emergency response, evacuation procedures and other contingency measures are determined.
2. Apply personal health and safety procedures	2.1 OHS policies and procedures are practiced and applied. 2.2 <u>Personal Protective Equipment (PPE)</u> is selected and used. 2.3 Personal hygiene is practiced.
3. Report hazards and risks	3.1 <u>Hazards and risks</u> are identified, assessed and controlled. 3.2 Incidents arising from hazards and risks are reported to authority. 3.3 Corrective actions are implemented to correct unsafe conditions in the workplace.
4. Respond to emergencies	4.1 Alarms and warning devices are responded. 4.2 <u>Emergency response plans and procedures</u> are implemented. 4.3 First aid procedure is applied during emergency situations.

Range of Variables

Variable	Range
	May include but not limited to:
1. OHS policies	1.1 International/ Local OHS requirements 1.2 Bangladesh Standards for OHS Building Code

	1.3 Fire Safety Rules and Regulations
2. Personal Protective Equipment (PPE)	2.1 Apron 2.2 Gas Mask 2.3 Gloves 2.4 Safety shoes 2.5 Face mask 2.6 Goggles 2.7 Ear plugs 2.8 Scarf
3. Hazards and risks	3.1 Chemical hazards 3.2 Biological hazards 3.3 Physical Hazards 3.4 Machine hazards 3.5 Materials hazards 3.6 Tools and Equipment hazards
4. Emergency response plans and procedures	4.1 Firefighting procedures 4.2 Earthquake response procedures 4.3 Evacuation procedures 4.4 Medical and first-aid

Curricular Content Guide:

1. Underpinning Knowledge	1.1 OHS workplace policies and procedures 1.2 Work safety procedures 1.3 Emergency procedures – firefighting, earthquake response, explosion response & accident response 1.4 Types of hazards – biological, chemical & physical, and their effects 1.5 PPE types and uses 1.6 Personal hygiene practices 1.7 OHS awareness 1.8 Malfunctions and resolutions
2. Underpinning Skills	2.1 Identifying OHS policies and procedures 2.2 Applying personal work safety practices in the workplace 2.3 Identifying, assessing and controlling hazards and risks 2.4 Reporting incidents arising from hazards and risks 2.5 Responding to emergency procedures 2.6 Maintaining physical well-being in the workplace 2.7 Implementing emergency response plans and procedures 2.8 Applying basic first aid procedures
3. Underpinning Attitudes	3.1 Commitment to occupational health and safety 3.2 Promptness in carrying out activities 3.3 Sincerity and honesty to duties 3.4 Environmental concerns 3.5 Eagerness to learn 3.6 Tidiness and timeliness

	3.7 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in the workplace 3.8 Good relationships with peers, sub-ordinates and seniors in the workplace
4. Resource Implications	4.1 Workplace (simulated or actual) 4.2 PPEs 4.3 Firefighting equipment 4.4 Emergency response manual 4.5 First aid kits 4.6 Learning manual

Assessment Evidence Guide:

1. Critical Aspects of Competency	Assessment required evidence that the candidate: 1.1 applied OHS policies and procedures 1.2 selected and used personal protective equipment (PPE) 1.3 practiced personal health and safety procedures 1.4 identified, assessed and controlled hazards and risks 1.5 reported incidents arising from hazards and risks to the authority 1.6 implemented plans and procedures to respond emergencies 1.7 applied basic first aid procedure
2. Methods of Assessment	Methods of assessment should include: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical demonstration 2.3 Oral question 2.4 Portfolio (optional)
3. Context of Assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training 3.2 Assessment should be done by a certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.

Unit of Competency: CARRY OUT WORKPLACE INTERACTION IN ENGLISH	Nominal Duration: 10 hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-ICT-ITF-02-G
Unit Descriptor: This unit covers the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to carry out workplace interaction in English. It specifically includes the tasks of interpreting workplace communication and etiquette, reading and understanding workplace documents, participating in workplace meetings and discussions, and practicing professional ethics at workplace.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Interpret workplace communication and etiquette	1.1 Workplace code of conducts are interpreted as per organizational guidelines. 1.2 Appropriate lines of communication are maintained with supervisors and colleagues. 1.3 Workplace interactions are conducted in a <u>courteous manner</u> to gather and convey information. 1.4 Questions about routine <u>workplace procedures and matters</u> are asked and responded as required.
2. Read and understand workplace documents	1.5 Workplace documents are interpreted as per standard. 1.6 Assistance is taken to aid comprehension when required from peers/supervisors. 1.7 Visual information/symbols/signages are understood and followed. 1.8 Specific and relevant information are accessed from <u>appropriate sources</u> . 1.9 Appropriate medium is used to transfer information and ideas.
3. Participate in workplace meetings and discussions	1.10 Team meetings are attended on time and followed meeting procedures and etiquette. 1.11 Own opinions are expressed and listened to those of others without interruption. 1.12 Inputs are provided consistent with the meeting purpose and interpreted and implemented meeting outcomes.
4. Practice professional ethics at workplace	1.13 Responsibilities as a team member are demonstrated and kept promises and commitments made to others. 1.14 Tasks are performed in accordance with workplace procedures. 1.15 Confidentiality is respected and maintained. 1.16 Situations and actions considered inappropriate or which present a conflict of interest are avoided.

Range of Variables

Variable	Range May Include but not limited to:
1. Courteous manner	1.1 Effective questioning 1.2 Active listening 1.3 Speaking skills
2. Workplace procedures and matters	1.4 Notes 1.5 Agenda 1.6 Simple reports such as progress and incident reports 1.7 Job sheets 1.8 Operational manuals 1.9 Brochures and promotional material 1.10 Visual and graphic materials 1.11 Standards 1.12 OSH information 1.13 Signs
3. Appropriate sources	1.14 HR Department 1.15 Managers 1.16 Supervisors

Curricular Content Guide:

1. Underpinning Knowledge	1.1 Workplace code of conducts 1.2 Workplace documents, signs and symbols 1.3 Meeting procedure and etiquette
2. Underpinning Skills	2.1 Demonstrating performance of workplace communication and etiquette 2.2 Applying workplace information and symbols/signages 2.3 Applying workplace code of conducts as per organizational guidelines 2.4 Providing inputs in the meeting consistent with the meeting purpose 2.5 Interpreting and implementing meeting outcomes 2.6 Practicing professional ethics at workplace 2.7 Avoiding tactfully situations and actions considered inappropriate or which presents a conflict of interest
3. Underpinning Attitudes	3.1 Commitment to occupational health and safety 3.2 Promptness in carrying out activities 3.3 Sincerity and honesty to duties 3.4 Environmental concerns 3.5 Eagerness to learn 3.6 Tidiness and timeliness 3.7 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in the workplace 3.8 Good relationships with peers, sub-ordinates and seniors in the workplace
4. Resource Implications	The following resources must be provided: 4.1 Workplace (simulated or actual) 4.2 Work book

	4.3 Learning & operational manuals 4.4 Workplace tools/equipment 4.5 Relevant tools, equipment, software and facilities needed to perform the activities
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Assessment Evidence Guide:

1. Critical Aspects of Competency	Assessment required evidence that the candidate: 1.1 interpreted workplace communication and etiquette 1.2 practiced workplace code of conducts as per organizational guidelines 1.3 Interpreted workplace documents, instructions and symbols 1.4 participated in workplace meetings and discussions 1.5 interpreted and implemented meeting outcomes 1.6 practiced professional ethics at workplace
2. Methods of Assessment	Methods of assessment may include but not limited to: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical demonstration 2.3 Oral questioning 2.4 Portfolio (optional)
3. Context of Assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training 3.2 Assessment should be done by a certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert

The Sector Specific Competencies

Unit of Competency: OPERATE OFFICE APPLICATION SOFTWARE	Nominal Duration: 30 hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-ICT-ITF-01-S
Unit Descriptor: This unit covers the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to operate office application software. It specifically includes the tasks of operating computer, installing application software, using word processor to prepare/create documents, using spreadsheet to create/prepare worksheets, using presentation software to create/prepare presentation and printing a document.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Operate computer	1.1 Safe workplace practices are observed according to IT workplace guideline. 1.2 Desktop <u>Peripherals</u> are checked and connected with computer properly. 1.3 Computer is switched on. 1.4 Computer <u>desktop/GUI settings</u> are arranged and customized as per requirement. 1.5 Files and folders are <u>manipulated</u> as per requirement. 1.6 Properties of files and folders are viewed and searched. 1.7 Disks are defragmented, formatted as per requirement.
2. Install application software	2.1 Installation requirements of software are identified and listed. 2.2 Software sources and CD key/ password are assured. 2.3 <u>Appropriate Software</u> are collected and selected as per requirement. 2.4 Software installation is started. 2.5 Customization is done as per requirement. 2.6 Steps of installation are followed as per installation Instructions. 2.7 Installations are completed properly. 2.8 Correctness of Installation is checked.
3. Use word processor to prepare/create documents	3.1 Appropriate <u>word processor</u> is selected and started. 3.2 Documents are created as per requirement in personal use and office environment. 3.3 Contents are entered. 3.4 Documents are formatted. 3.5 Paragraph and page settings are completed. 3.6 Document is saved.
4. Use spreadsheet to	4.1 <u>Spreadsheet applications</u> are selected and started.

create/prepare worksheets	4.2 Worksheets are created as per requirement in personal use and office environment. 4.3 Data are entered. 4.4 Functions are used for calculating and editing logical operation. 4.5 Sheets are formatted as per requirement. 4.6 Charts are created. 4.7 Charts/sheets are saved.
5. Use presentation software to create/prepare presentation	5.1 Appropriate <u>presentation applications</u> are selected and started. 5.2 Presentations are created as per requirement in personal use and office environment 5.3 Image, illustrations, text, table, symbols and media are entered as per requirements. 5.4 Presentations are formatted and animated. 5.5 Presentations are viewed and saved.
6. Print a document	6.1. Printer is connected with computer. 6.2. Power is switched on at both the power outlet and printer. 6.3. Printer is installed and added. 6.4. Paper of proper size is put into printer. 6.5. Correct printer setting is selected 6.6. Document is previewed and printed. 6.7. Print from the printer spool is viewed or cancelled and unsaved data is saved as per requirements. 6.8. Opened software is closed. 6.9. Devices are shut down.

Range of Variables

Variable	Range May include but not limited to:
1. Peripherals	1.1 Monitor 1.2 Keyboard 1.3 Mouse 1.4 Modem 1.5 Scanner 1.6 Printer
2. Desktop settings	2.1 Icons 2.2 Taskbar 2.3 View 2.4 Resolutions
3. Manipulate	3.1 Create 3.2 Open 3.3 Copy 3.4 Rename 3.5 Delete 3.6 Sort
4. Typing tutors	4.1 English typing tutor

	4.2 Bangla typing tutor
5. Appropriate software	5.1 MS office or Open office but limited to 5.2 Word processor software. 5.3 Spread sheet software 5.4 Presentation software
6. Word processor	6.1 MS Word processor 6.2 Open office Org 6.3 Google docs 6.4 Word perfect 6.5 LibreOffice
7. Spread sheet applications	7.1 MS Excel 7.2 Google Sheets 7.3 Apple Numbers by Apple
8. Presentation application	8.1 MS PowerPoint 8.2 Google Slides 8.3 Prezi

Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning Knowledge	1.1 Desktop items 1.2 Type of Bangla keyboard layout 1.3 Different types of software and application packages 1.4 Use of word processor, spread sheet and presentation software 1.5 Types of printers 1.6 Types of charts, impotence of chart 1.7 Different types of math and logical functions
2. Underpinning Skills	2.1 Starting computer 2.2 Installing operating system 2.3 Managing desktop item 2.4 Manipulating files and folders as per requirement 2.5 Installing application software 2.6 Running application software 2.7 Creating and saving document with word processing application 2.8 Using functions in spread sheet. 2.9 Applying animations into presentation slide 2.10 Printing document
3. Underpinning Attitudes	3.1 Commitment to occupational health and safety 3.2 Promptness in carrying out activities 3.3 Sincerity and honesty to duties 3.4 Environmental concerns 3.5 Eagerness to learn 3.6 Tidiness and timeliness 3.7 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in the workplace 3.8 Good relationships with peers, sub-ordinates and seniors in the workplace
4. Resource Implications	4.1 Workplace (simulated or actual)

	4.2 Computer/laptop 4.3 Scanner, printer 4.4 Software 4.5 Work books 4.6 Relevant tools, equipment and facilities needed to perform the activities 4.7 Required learning materials
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Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical Aspects of Competency	Assessment required evidence that the candidate: 1.1 installed operating system 1.2 manipulated files and folders as per requirement 1.3 Installed appropriate application software 1.4 used word processor to prepare/create documents 1.5 used spreadsheet to create/prepare worksheets 1.6 Used presentation software to create/prepare presentation 1.7 applied animations into presentation slides 1.8 printed document
2. Methods of Assessment	Competency should be assessed by: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical demonstration 2.3 Oral questioning 2.4 Portfolio (optional)
3. Context of Assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training. 3.2 Assessment should be done by a nationally certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.

The Occupation Specific Competencies

Unit of Competency: APPLY BASIC KNOWLEDGE OF IT FREELANCING	Nominal Duration: 20 hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-ICT-ITF-01-O
Unit Descriptor: This unit covers the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to apply basic knowledge of IT freelancing. It specifically includes the tasks of identifying basics of IT freelancing, using different freelancing platforms and creating and maintaining a professional portfolio.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Identify concept and scope of IT freelancing.	1.1. The concept and scope of IT freelancing are identified and defined. 1.2. Various <u>IT freelancing opportunities</u> are recognized and listed. 1.3. Required <u>technical skills</u> for freelancing are identified and explained. 1.4. <u>Payment procedures</u> and methods used in IT freelancing are explained.
2. Use different freelancing platforms.	1.5. Working processes and functionalities of each platform are explained. 1.6. <u>Platforms</u> are accessed and navigated to search for relevant freelancing jobs. 1.7. Job opportunities are evaluated and shortlisted based on requirements. 1.8. Communication tools within the platforms are used to interact with clients.
3. Create and maintain a professional portfolio.	1.9. The concept and purpose of a professional portfolio are explained. 1.10. A personal portfolio is created with relevant work samples and achievements. 1.11. Portfolio content is updated regularly to reflect current skills and projects. 1.12. Portfolio is organized to highlight strengths and competencies clearly. 1.13. Portfolio is used effectively to apply for freelancing jobs.

Range of Variables

Variable	Range
	May include but not limited to:
1. IT Freelancing	1.1 Web development (frontend, backend, full-stack)

opportunities	1.2 Mobile app development (iOS, Android, cross-platform like Flutter or React Native) 1.3 UI/UX design, prototyping 1.4 Graphic design, motion graphics 1.5 Digital Marketing (SEO, SEM, social media, funnel building) 1.6 Content creation & copywriting 1.7 E-commerce work: setting up Shopify stores, Amazon/AliExpress listings, dropshipping support, product data entry 1.8 Virtual assistant / administrative tech support 1.9 Automation & scripting (e.g. small workflows, bots) 1.10 Data analytics, dashboards, visualization 1.11 Cybersecurity basics (vulnerability checks, secure setup) 1.12 No-code / low-code solutions: website builders, tools like Webflow, Airtable, Zapier
2. Technical skills	2.1 Typing 2.2 Chatting 2.3 Browsing 2.4 AI operation 2.5 Presenting 2.6 Negotiating
3. Payment procedure	3.1 PayPal 3.2 Payoneer 3.3 Skrill 3.4 Bank transfer 3.5 Western Union 3.6 Mobile banking 3.7 Internet banking
4. Platforms	4.1 Fiverr 4.2 Upwork 4.3 Kwork 4.4 PeoplePerHour 4.5 Freelancer.com 4.6 Toptal 4.7 Guru 4.8 Truelancer 4.9 99designs 4.10 SimplyHired 4.11 Workana

Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning Knowledge	1.1 Concept of IT freelancing as independent online work done for different clients.
	1.2 Scope of IT freelancing across areas like development,

	design, writing, marketing, support, and other digital services. 1.3 Common IT freelancing opportunities available on global marketplaces. 1.4 Basic understanding of how freelancing platforms function from profile creation to job completion. 1.5 Process of navigating platforms to find suitable job listings and understand client requirements. 1.6 Basic idea of how payment methods work, including fixed, hourly, and milestone systems. 1.7 Common components of a portfolio such as projects, achievements, and personal information. 1.8 Importance of updating and organizing the portfolio to highlight strengths and stay relevant.
2. Underpinning Skills	2.1 Identifying concepts, scopes, and opportunities related to IT freelancing. 2.2 Analyzing required technical skills for specific freelancing roles. 2.3 Using major freelancing platforms and navigating their interfaces efficiently. 2.4 Searching for relevant jobs using filters, keywords, and platform tools. 2.5 Communicating with clients using platform-based messaging, chat, and video tools. 2.6 Creating a professional portfolio with organized work samples and achievements. 2.7 Updating portfolio content regularly to reflect evolving skills and new projects. 2.8 Applying the portfolio effectively when bidding for freelance jobs.
3. Underpinning Attitudes	3.1 Commitment to occupational health and safety 3.2 Promptness in carrying out activities 3.3 Sincerity and honesty to duties 3.4 Environmental concerns 3.5 Eagerness to learn 3.6 Tidiness and timeliness 3.7 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in the workplace 3.8 Good relationships with peers, sub-ordinates and seniors in the workplace
4. Resource Implications	The following resources must be provided: 4.1 Workplace (simulated or actual) 4.2 Computer/laptop/notebook 4.3 Relevant tools 4.4 Required learning materials

Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical Aspects of	Assessment must evidence that the candidate:
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Competency	1.1 identified basics of IT freelancing. 1.2 used different freelancing platforms. 1.3 created and maintained a professional portfolio.
2. Methods of Assessment	Methods of assessment should include: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical demonstration 2.3 Oral questioning 2.4 Portfolio (optional)
3. Context of Assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training. 3.2 Assessment should be done by a nationally certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.

Unit of Competency: PERFORM DATA ENTRY	Nominal Duration: 40 hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-ICT-ITF-02-O
Unit Descriptor: This unit covers the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to perform data entry. It specifically includes the tasks of identifying types and sources of data entry work, using common data entry tools and software, carrying out accurate and efficient data entry and reviewing and correcting data errors.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Identify types and sources of data entry work.	1.1 Data entry work is defined and its scope is explained. 1.2 <u>Tools</u> for data entry are identified and described. 1.3 Sources of data entry work are explored and documented. 1.4 Techniques for collecting and organizing data are applied correctly. 1.5 Data requirements are analyzed to ensure completeness and accuracy. 1.6 Data entry tasks are categorized based on type and source. 1.7 Findings on data sources and tools are recorded for reference.
2. Use common data entry tools and software	2.1 <u>Common data entry software</u> is identified and listed. 2.2 Software applications are accessed and navigated for data entry tasks. 2.3 Data is entered accurately using appropriate tools and formats. 2.4 Shortcuts and features of the software are applied to improve efficiency. 2.5 Errors in data entry are detected and corrected promptly. 2.6 Data entry activities are monitored to ensure compliance with standards.
3. Carryout accurate and efficient data entry.	3.1 Data entry work is collected accurately from designated portals and manually. 3.2 Data is entered using preferred tools and software efficiently. 3.3 Accuracy of entered data is checked against original sources. 3.4 <u>Quality parameters</u> for data entry are applied consistently. 3.5 Completed data entry tasks are reviewed and

	documented for verification.
4. Review and correct data errors.	4.1 Entered data is reviewed systematically for errors and inconsistencies. 4.2 Data discrepancies are identified and documented. 4.3 Errors are corrected using standard procedures and tools. 4.4 Corrected data is verified against original sources for accuracy. 4.5 Data quality is monitored continuously to prevent recurring errors. 4.6 Changes and corrections are recorded for accountability. 4.7 Reports on data accuracy and corrections are prepared and submitted.

Range of Variables

Variable	Range May include but not limited to:
1. Tools	1.1 Google doc 1.2 Google spreadsheet 1.3 Word processor 1.4 Spreadsheet 1.5 Note pad
2. Common data entry software	2.1 Google Sheets 2.2 Microsoft Excel 2.3 Microsoft Access 2.4 Oracle Forms / Oracle NetSuite 2.5 Zoho Creator 2.6 QuickBooks (for financial data) 2.7 Tally ERP 2.8 Airtable 2.9 LibreOffice Calc 2.10 SAP Data Entry Modules
3. Quality parameters	3.1 Accuracy 3.2 Completeness 3.3 Consistency 3.4 Timeliness / Speed 3.5 Formatting compliance 3.6 Data validation / error checking 3.7 Adherence to guidelines or standards 3.8 Duplication avoidance 3.9 Readability / Clarity

Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning Knowledge	1.1 Basic idea of data entry work, its purpose, and the range of tasks involved. 1.2 Common tools used for data entry, including word
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	processors, spreadsheets, and online forms. 1.3 Techniques for collecting, sorting, and organizing data before entry. 1.4 Data requirements related to completeness, accuracy, and relevance. 1.5 Features, menus, and tools in software applications that support efficient data entry. 1.6 Quality parameters such as accuracy, consistency, formatting, and clarity. 1.7 Types of data errors and reasons for reviewing data systematically. 1.8 Process of verifying entered data against original sources to ensure accuracy.
2. Underpinning Skills	2.1 Collecting and organizing data using correct techniques. 2.2 Analyzing data requirements to ensure accuracy and completeness. 2.3 Recording findings related to tools, data types, and sources. 2.4 Using common data entry software and navigating their interfaces. 2.5 Entering data accurately in various formats and layouts. 2.6 Applying software shortcuts and built-in features to improve speed and efficiency. 2.7 Carrying out data entry using both online portals and manual sources. 2.8 Applying defined quality parameters throughout the entry process. 2.9 Preparing and submitting reports on data accuracy and corrections.
3. Underpinning Attitudes	3.1 Commitment to occupational health and safety 3.2 Promptness in carrying out activities 3.3 Sincerity and honesty to duties 3.4 Environmental concerns 3.5 Eagerness to learn 3.6 Tidiness and timeliness 3.7 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in the workplace 3.8 Good relationships with peers, sub-ordinates and seniors in the workplace
4. Resource Implications	The following resources must be provided: 4.1 Workplace (simulated or actual) 4.2 Computer/laptop/notebook 4.3 Multimedia 4.4 Required learning materials

Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical Aspects of Competency	Assessment must evidence that the candidate: 1.1 identified types and sources of data entry work. 1.2 used common data entry tools and software 1.3 carried out accurate and efficient data entry. 1.4 reviewed and corrected data errors.
2. Methods of Assessment	Methods of assessment should include: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical demonstration 2.3 Oral questioning 2.4 Portfolio (optional)
3. Context of Assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training. 3.2 Assessment should be done by a nationally certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.

Unit of Competency: PERFORM BASIC GRAPHIC DESIGN TASKS	Nominal Duration: 30 hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-ICT-ITF-03-O
Unit Descriptor: This unit covers the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to perform basic graphic design. It specifically includes the tasks of identifying basic principles of graphic design, using design tools (Canva or adobe photoshop), creating simple designs for social media and web use and editing and formatting images.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Identify basic principles of graphic design.	1.1 <u>Fundamental principles of graphic design</u> are identified and explained. 1.2 <u>Elements</u> are recognized. 1.3 The role of design principles in effective visual communication is described. 1.4 <u>Examples of good and poor design</u> are analyzed. 1.5 Basic design standards and aesthetics are interpreted for practical application.
2. Use design tools (Canva or Adobe Photoshop).	2.1 Canva or Adobe Photoshop is identified and installed. 2.2 <u>Basic tools and functions</u> are explored and used. 2.3 Design elements are created and edited using Canva or Photoshop. 2.4 Completed designs are saved and exported in <u>appropriate formats</u> .
3. Create simple designs for social media and web use.	3.1 Design requirements for social media and web use are identified. 3.2 Suitable templates, layouts, and dimensions are selected. 3.3 <u>Visual elements</u> are added and adjusted. 3.4 Designs are reviewed and refined for clarity and attractiveness. 3.5 Final designs are saved and shared in proper formats.
4. Edit and format images	4.1 Images are opened and reviewed using appropriate graphic design software. 4.2 Basic editing functions and color adjustment are applied. 4.3 Unwanted elements or imperfections in images are removed. 4.4 Text, filters, and effects are adjusted as required by the design brief. 4.5 Edited images are formatted according to project

	specifications.
	4.6 Final images are saved and exported in suitable file formats.

Range of Variables

Variable	Range May include but not limited to:
1. Fundamental principles of graphic design	1.1 Balance 1.2 Contrast 1.3 Emphasis 1.4 Alignment 1.5 Proximity 1.6 Repetition 1.7 Hierarchy 1.8 Unity 1.9 White space
2. Elements	2.1 Line 2.2 Shape 2.3 Color 2.4 Texture 2.5 Space 2.6 Form 2.7 Typography 2.8 Balance 2.9 Contrast
3. Examples of good and poor design	3.1 Good design: 3.1.1 Clear layout 3.1.2 Consistent alignment 3.1.3 Proper color contrast 3.1.4 Balanced composition 3.2 Poor design: 3.2.1 Cluttered layout 3.2.2 Inconsistent fonts 3.2.3 Poor contrast 3.2.4 Misaligned elements
4. Basic tools and functions	4.1 Selection 4.2 Move 4.3 Crop 4.4 Text 4.5 Brush 4.6 Shape 4.7 Layer 4.8 Filter 4.9 Color adjustment 4.10 Alignment tools
5. Appropriate formats	5.1 PNG 5.2 JPEG

	5.3 PSD (Photoshop) 5.4 PDF 5.5 SVG (print, web, or social media)
6. Visual elements	6.1 Text 6.2 Fonts 6.3 Colors 6.4 Shapes 6.5 Icons 6.6 Images 6.7 Logos 6.8 Backgrounds

Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning Knowledge	1.1 Basic idea of graphic design principles like balance, contrast, alignment, and hierarchy. 1.2 Key elements of design such as color, shape, typography, space, and images. 1.3 Purpose of design principles in creating clear and effective visual communication. 1.4 Differences between good and poor design through simple examples. 1.5 Basic design standards and common visual aesthetics used in practical work. 1.6 General understanding of Canva and Adobe Photoshop as popular design tools. 1.7 Common tools and functions in design software for creating and editing visual elements. 1.8 Basic requirements for social media and web design, including templates, layouts, and sizes. 1.9 Essential steps in editing images adding text or effects.
2. Underpinning Skills	2.1 Analyzing examples of strong and weak design for practical understanding. 2.2 Applying basic design standards and aesthetics in real tasks. 2.3 Creating and editing visual elements such as shapes, text, icons, and images. 2.4 Assessing design requirements for social media and web platforms. 2.5 Sharing final designs using correct formats and quality settings. 2.6 Applying basic edits, including cropping, resizing, and color adjustments. 2.7 Adjusting text, filters, and effects as needed for the design brief. 2.8 Formatting edited images according to project specifications. 2.9 Exporting final images in suitable file formats.

3. Underpinning Attitudes	3.1 Commitment to occupational health and safety 3.2 Promptness in carrying out activities 3.3 Sincerity and honesty to duties 3.4 Environmental concerns 3.5 Eagerness to learn 3.6 Tidiness and timeliness 3.7 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in the workplace 3.8 Good relationships with peers, sub-ordinates and seniors in the workplace
4. Resource Implications	The following resources must be provided: 4.1 Workplace (simulated or actual) 4.2 Computer/laptop/notebook 4.3 Multimedia 4.4 Required learning materials 4.5 Specifications and work instructions

Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical Aspects of Competency	Assessment must evidence that the candidate: 1.1 identified basic principles of graphic design. 1.2 used design tools (Canva or Adobe Photoshop). 1.3 created simple designs for social media and web use. 1.4 edited and formatted images.
2. Methods of Assessment	Methods of assessment should include: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical demonstration 2.3 Oral questioning 2.4 Portfolio (optional)
3. Context of Assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training. 3.2 Assessment should be done by a nationally certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.

Unit of Competency: PERFORM SEARCH ENGINE OPTIMIZATION (SEO)	Nominal Duration: 70 hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-ICT-ITF-04-O
Unit Descriptor: This unit of competency covers the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to perform search engine optimization (SEO). It specifically includes the tasks of identifying and interpreting SEO concepts, setting up and manage websites for SEO, applying on-page SEO techniques, applying off-page SEO techniques, implementing mobile SEO techniques, measuring and reporting SEO performance.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Identify and interpret SEO concepts.	1.1. Basic HTML requirements and HTML tags for SEO are identified and documented. 1.2. <u>Search engines</u> are identified and their functions are explained. 1.3. <u>Actions performed by search engines</u> during searches are observed and interpreted. 1.4. <u>Search Engine Optimization (SEO)</u> is defined and relevant <u>tools</u> are identified. 1.5. Spamming practices are explained and recognized. 1.6. SEO concepts are applied to analyze website visibility and ranking.
2. Set up and manage websites for SEO.	1.7. Domain name is chosen to optimize website visibility and SEO. 1.8. SEO-friendly file names and extensions are applied consistently. 1.9. Website design and layout are implemented to support SEO best practices. 1.10. <u>Files</u> are explained, created, and configured. 1.11. Website content is structured to enhance search engine indexing. 1.12. Navigation and linking are optimized for search engine friendliness. 1.13. SEO setup and configurations are reviewed and tested for effectiveness.
3. Apply on-page SEO techniques.	1.14. On-page SEO concepts are explained and understood. 1.15. <u>Keyword optimisation concepts</u> are interpreted and applied. 1.16. Meta tags and title tags are created and implemented for optimization. 1.17. Anchor texts are applied strategically to enhance

	SEO. 1.18. Unique and relevant content is added to improve search engine ranking. 1.19. WordPress pages and posts are updated using SEO best practices. 1.20. On-page SEO implementations are monitored and reviewed for effectiveness.
4. Apply off-page SEO techniques.	1.21. Off-page SEO concepts are explained and understood. 1.22. Relevant <u>off-page SEO techniques</u> are identified and documented. 1.23. Website authority and credibility are enhanced through applied off-page strategies. 1.24. Results of off-page SEO activities are monitored and recorded. 1.25. Deviations from best practices are identified and corrected. 1.26. Off-page SEO outcomes are reviewed to support continuous improvement.
5. Implement mobile SEO techniques.	1.27. Mobile SEO concepts are explained and understood. 1.28. Appropriate mobile configuration is selected and applied. 1.29. Google and other search engines are informed of the mobile-friendly site. 1.30. <u>Tools for mobile SEO</u> are identified, interpreted, and used effectively. 1.31. Mobile site usability and performance are monitored. 1.32. Issues affecting mobile SEO are detected and corrected. 1.33. Mobile SEO results are documented and reviewed for improvement.
6. Measure and report SEO performance.	6.1 <u>SEO performance metrics</u> are identified and defined. 6.2 Data on website traffic, ranking, and engagement are collected. 6.3 SEO tools are used to measure performance accurately. 6.4 Results are analyzed to identify strengths and weaknesses. 6.5 Deviations from SEO targets are detected and documented. 6.6 SEO performance reports are prepared and submitted to relevant personnel. 6.7 Findings are reviewed to support ongoing SEO strategy improvements.

Range of Variables

Variable	Range May include but not limited to:
1. Search engine	1.1 Google 1.2 Bing 1.3 Yahoo 1.4 DuckDuckGo 1.5 Ask.com
2. Actions of a search engine	2.1 Crawling 2.2 Indexing 2.3 Processing 2.4 Calculating relevancy 2.5 Retrieving results
3. Search engine optimization	3.1 On-page 3.2 Off-page 3.3 Technial SEO 3.4 Local SEO
4. Tools	4.1 Glossary 4.2 Forums 4.3 Conferences 4.4 Social bookmarking, tags, & buzz tools 4.5 Competitive analysis 4.6 Keyword selection 4.7 General SEO 4.8 Link checking functions 4.9 Link building 4.10 Aggressive SEO 4.11 Pay per click
5. Files	5.1 Robots.txt 5.2 Sitemap.html 5.3 Sitemap.xml 5.4 Urllist.txt
6. Keyword optimization concepts	6.1 Frequency 6.2 Weight 6.3 Proximity 6.4 Prominence 6.5 Placement 6.6 Finding keywords 6.7 Word stemming
7. Off-page SEO techniques	7.1 Backlink building (quality links from other websites) 7.2 Social media marketing and engagement 7.3 Influencer outreach and collaborations 7.4 Guest blogging on relevant websites 7.5 Forum participation and Q&A contributions 7.6 Blog commenting on authoritative sites 7.7 Content sharing on social bookmarking sites 7.8 Press releases and media coverage 7.9 Directory submissions (relevant and reputable)

	directories)
8. Tools for mobile SEO	8.1 Google Search Console (Mobile Performance Reports) 8.2 Google Analytics (Mobile Traffic Analysis) 8.3 PageSpeed Insights (Mobile Page Speed Testing) 8.4 Lighthouse (Mobile SEO Audit) 8.5 SEMrush (Mobile SEO Audit & Tracking) 8.6 Ahrefs (Mobile Keyword & Backlink Analysis) 8.7 Screaming Frog SEO Spider (Mobile Site Crawling) 8.8 Mobile-Friendly Test by Google
9. SEO performance metrics	9.1 Organic traffic 9.2 Keyword rankings 9.3 Click-through rate (CTR) 9.4 Bounce rate 9.5 Domain authority 9.6 Page authority 9.7 Backlinks (quantity and quality) 9.8 Pages per session 9.9 Conversion rate 9.10 Average session duration

Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning Knowledge	1.1 Basic idea of SEO and how search engines work, including crawling, indexing, and ranking. 1.2 Common HTML elements and tags that support SEO. 1.3 Key SEO concepts such as keywords, meta tags, anchor text, and website visibility. 1.4 Importance of domain names, file names, website structure, and navigation for SEO. 1.5 Core on-page SEO practices like keyword optimization, quality content, and proper tagging. 1.6 Main off-page SEO concepts such as backlinks, authority building, and external engagement. 1.7 Basics of mobile SEO, including mobile-friendly configuration and performance monitoring. 1.8 Common SEO tools used for tracking traffic, ranking, and site performance.
2. Underpinning Skills	2.1 Using search engines and SEO tools to assess visibility and ranking. 2.2 Avoiding spamming practices and following ethical SEO methods. 2.3 Applying SEO-friendly layouts, content structure, navigation, and linking. 2.4 Using on-page techniques such as keywords, meta tags, titles, and anchor text. 2.5 Adding clear and relevant content to improve ranking. 2.6 Updating and managing WordPress pages with SEO best practices. 2.7 Applying mobile SEO configurations and using mobile

	SEO tools. 2.8 Collecting and analyzing key SEO performance metrics. 2.9 Preparing and reviewing SEO performance reports.
3. Underpinning Attitudes	3.1 Commitment to occupational health and safety 3.2 Promptness in carrying out activities 3.3 Sincerity and honesty to duties 3.4 Environmental concerns 3.5 Eagerness to learn 3.6 Tidiness and timeliness 3.7 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in the workplace 3.8 Good relationships with peers, sub-ordinates and seniors in the workplace
4. Resource Implications	The following resources must be provided: 4.1 Workplace (simulated or actual) 4.2 Computer/laptop 4.3 Specifications and work instructions 4.4 Learning materials

Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical Aspects of Competency	Assessment must evidence that the candidate: 1.1 identified and interpreted SEO concepts. 1.2 set up and managed websites for SEO. 1.3 applied on-page SEO techniques. 1.4 applied off-page SEO techniques. 1.5 implemented mobile SEO techniques. 1.6 measured and reported SEO performance.
2. Methods of Assessment	Methods of assessment should include: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical demonstration 2.3 Oral questioning 2.4 Portfolio (optional)
3. Context of Assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training. 3.2 Assessment should be done by a nationally certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.

Unit of Competency: PERFORM SOCIAL MEDIA MARKETING (SMM)	Nominal Duration: 60 hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-ICT-ITF-05-O
Unit Descriptor: This unit of competency covers the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to perform social media marketing (SMM). It specifically includes the tasks of identifying major social media platforms, creating and managing social media pages or profiles, developing and posting engaging content, running paid and organic marketing campaigns, analyzing social media performance and insights and improving strategy based on results and feedback.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Identify major social media platforms.	1.1. <u>Major social media platforms</u> are identified and listed. 1.2. Features and functions of each platform are explained. 1.3. Target audience and usage of each platform are analyzed. 1.4. Platforms are categorized based on purpose and reach. 1.5. Observations on platform trends and popularity are documented. 1.6. Social media platforms are compared for relevance to business or personal goals.
2. Create and manage social media pages or profiles.	2.1. <u>Social media pages or profiles</u> are created on selected platforms. 2.2. Profile information and branding elements are added and updated. 2.3. <u>Content</u> is posted and organized according to platform guidelines. 2.4. Pages or profiles are monitored for engagement and interactions. 2.5. <u>Privacy and security settings</u> are applied and maintained. 2.6. Updates and changes to profiles are recorded for consistency. 2.7. Performance of social media pages or profiles is reviewed regularly.
3. Develop and post engaging content.	3.1. <u>Content topics and themes</u> are identified based on audience and objectives. 3.2. Content is created in formats suitable for each social media platform.

	3.3 Posts are optimized for engagement and visibility. 3.4 Content is scheduled and published according to a content calendar. 3.5 Comments and shares are monitored and responded. 3.6 Engagement metrics are recorded and analyzed. 3.7 Content strategy is adjusted based on performance and feedback.
4. Run paid and organic marketing campaigns.	4.1 <u>Paid and organic marketing campaigns</u> are planned and approved. 4.2 Target audience and campaign objectives are identified. 4.3 Campaigns are launched on selected social media platforms. 4.4 <u>Performance metrics</u> are monitored. 4.5 Campaigns are adjusted based on real-time performance data. 4.6 Budget and resources for paid campaigns are tracked and recorded. 4.7 Results of campaigns are documented and reported for evaluation and improvement.
5. Analyze social media performance and insights.	5.1 Social media performance metrics are collected from relevant platforms. 5.2 Data on engagement, reach, and audience behavior are analyzed. 5.3 Insights are generated to identify trends and patterns. 5.4 <u>Strengths and weaknesses</u> of social media activities are determined. 5.5 Reports on performance and insights are prepared and documented. 5.6 Recommendations for improving social media strategy are formulated. 5.7 Findings are reviewed periodically to support continuous optimization.
6. Improve strategy based on results and feedback.	6.1 <u>Results and feedback</u> from social media activities are collected and reviewed. 6.2 Performance gaps and areas for improvement are identified. 6.3 Strategies are adjusted based on data-driven insights. 6.4 <u>Changes</u> are implemented in content, campaigns, and engagement practices. 6.5 Updated strategies are monitored for effectiveness and impact. 6.6 Improvements and outcomes are documented for future reference. 6.7 Continuous optimization is maintained based on ongoing results and feedback.

Range of Variables

Variable	Range May include but not limited to:
1. Major social media platforms	1.1 Facebook 1.2 Instagram 1.3 Twitter/X 1.4 LinkedIn 1.5 TikTok 1.6 YouTube 1.7 Pinterest 1.8 Snapchat
2. Social media pages or profiles	2.1 Facebook Page 2.2 Instagram Account 2.3 LinkedIn Profile 2.4 Twitter/X Profile 2.5 TikTok Account 2.6 YouTube Channel
3. Content	3.1 Posts 3.2 Stories 3.3 Reels 3.4 Videos 3.5 Carousels 3.6 Captions 3.7 Hashtags 3.8 Scheduling frequency
4. Privacy and security settings	4.1 Account privacy 4.2 Two-factor authentication 4.3 Content moderation 4.4 Restricted access
5. Content topics and themes	5.1 Product updates 5.2 Promotions 5.3 Tutorials 5.4 Tips 5.5 Industry news 5.6 User-generated content 5.7 Entertainment
6. Paid and organic marketing campaigns	6.1 Paid campaigns 6.1.1 YouTube Ads 6.1.2 Google Ads 6.1.3 Instagram Ads 6.1.4 TikTok Ads 6.1.5 Facebook Ads 6.1.6 LinkedIn Ads 6.2 Organic campaigns 6.2.1 Regular posts 6.2.2 Hashtags Engagement drives 6.2.3 Contests

7. Performance metrics	7.1 Reach 7.2 Impressions 7.3 Clicks 7.4 Click-through rate (CTR) 7.5 Conversions 7.6 Engagement rate 7.7 Cost per result
8. Strengths and weaknesses	8.1 High-performing content types 8.2 Low-performing posts 8.3 Engagement gaps 8.4 Audience responsiveness
9. Results and feedback	9.1 Campaign performance 9.2 Audience comments 9.3 Survey feedback 9.4 Engagement metrics
10. Changes	10.1 Updating posts 10.2 Redesigning campaigns 10.3 Adjusting hashtags 10.4 Improving visual or textual content

Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning Knowledge	1.1 Major social media platforms and their general features, functions, and user groups. 1.2 Common purposes of different platforms. 1.3 Basic principles of creating and maintaining social media pages or profiles. 1.4 Platform guidelines, content formats, and posting practices used for organizing and publishing content. 1.5 Key ideas behind engaging content. 1.6 Differences between organic and paid campaigns and how campaign goals guide platform selection. 1.7 Main social media performance metrics. 1.8 Methods of analyzing audience behavior and identifying trends for strategy improvement. 1.9 Basic concepts of continuous optimization based on results, feedback, and performance gaps.
2. Underpinning Skills	2.1 Creating and maintaining social media pages or profiles. 2.2 Adding branding elements and updating profile information. 2.3 Posting, organizing, and monitoring content for engagement. 2.4 Creating platform-appropriate content in different formats. 2.5 Optimizing posts for visibility and interaction. 2.6 Scheduling and publishing content consistently. 2.7 Planning and running paid and organic campaigns. 2.8 Tracking budgets and documenting campaign results.

	2.9 Preparing reports and recommending improvements.
3. Underpinning Attitudes	3.1 Commitment to occupational health and safety 3.2 Promptness in carrying out activities 3.3 Sincerity and honesty to duties 3.4 Environmental concerns 3.5 Eagerness to learn 3.6 Tidiness and timeliness 3.7 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in the workplace 3.8 Good relationships with peers, sub-ordinates and seniors in the workplace
4. Resource Implications	The following resources must be provided: 4.1 Workplace (simulated or actual) 4.2 Computer/laptop 4.3 Specifications and work instructions 4.4 Learning materials

Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical Aspects of Competency	Assessment must evidence that the candidate: 1.1 identified major social media platforms. 1.2 created and managed social media pages or profiles. 1.3 developed and post engaging content. 1.4 runned paid and organic marketing campaigns. 1.5 analyze social media performance and insights. 1.6 improved strategy based on results and feedback.
2. Methods of Assessment	Methods of assessment should include: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical demonstration 2.3 Oral questioning 2.4 Portfolio (optional)
3. Context of Assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training. 3.2 Assessment should be done by a nationally certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.

Unit of Competency: PERFORM AFFILIATE MARKETING	Nominal Duration: 40 hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-ICT-ITF-06-O
Unit Descriptor: This unit covers the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to perform affiliate marketing. It specifically includes the tasks of explaining the concept and process of affiliate marketing, identifying suitable affiliate programs and products, creating content for affiliate promotion, carrying out affiliate marketing activities and developing strategies to increase conversion and income.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Explain the concept and process of affiliate marketing.	1.1. Affiliate marketing and related <u>common terms</u> are defined clearly. 1.2. <u>Basic payment methods</u> used in affiliate marketing are explained. 1.3. Popular <u>affiliate marketing platforms</u> are identified and described. 1.4. Key steps in setting up an affiliate marketing workflow are explained. 1.5. Information about tracking links and conversions is interpreted.
2. Identify suitable affiliate programs and products.	2.1. Suitable affiliate platforms are identified and selected. 2.2. Affiliate systems are integrated with the online store as required. 2.3. Appropriate <u>affiliate marketing tools</u> are used to support campaign activities. 2.4. Convenient and secure payment systems are set up for commission processing. 2.5. Selected programs and products are reviewed for relevance and profitability. 2.6. Documentation of chosen affiliate programs is maintained for future use.
3. Create content for affiliate promotion.	3.1. Content requirements for affiliate promotion are identified and outlined. 3.2. Relevant information about products and affiliate links is collected and organized. 3.3. Content is optimized for audience engagement and platform guidelines. 3.4. <u>Content</u> is created according to the promotion plan. 3.5. Affiliate links are placed correctly within the content. 3.6. Created content is reviewed and revised for clarity and accuracy. 3.7. Final promotional content is published or scheduled on

	selected platforms.
4. Carryout affiliate marketing activities.	4.1 Affiliate marketing activities are planned and executed according to the strategy. 4.2 Promotional content is shared across selected platforms. 4.3 Affiliate links are used correctly to track clicks and conversions. 4.4 Audience engagement and traffic are monitored regularly. 4.5 Campaign performance data is collected and reviewed. 4.6 Adjustments to marketing activities are made based on results. 4.7 Affiliate activities are documented for evaluation and future improvement.
5. Develop strategies to increase conversion and income.	5.1 <u>Common challenges</u> in affiliate marketing are identified through analysis. 5.2 Suitable solutions to these challenges are identified and implemented. 5.3 <u>Powerful techniques</u> for boosting conversions are identified and applied. 5.4 Strategies for increasing income are developed based on performance data. 5.5 Improvements are monitored and adjusted as needed. 5.6 Results of implemented strategies are documented for future use.

Range of Variables

Variable	Range
	May include but not limited to:
1. Common terms	1.1 Affiliate 1.2 Associate 1.3 Merchant 1.4 Power affiliate 1.5 Testimonial 1.6 Traffic
2. Basic payment methods	2.1 Pay-per-sale (cost-per-sale) 2.2 Pay-per-click (cost-per-click) 2.3 Pay-per-lead (cost-per-lead)
3. Affiliate marketing platforms	3.1 Amazon associates 3.2 Ebay 3.3 Rakuten LinkShare 3.4 Clickbank 3.5 CJ affiliate 3.6 AvantLink 3.7 ShareASale 3.8 Avangate

	3.9 Flexoffers 3.10 RevenueWire
4. Affiliate marketing tools	4.1 Semrush 4.2 Tapiliate 4.3 Refersion 4.4 impact.com 4.5 ShareASale 4.6 Amazon Associates 4.7 ClickBank 4.8 CJ (Commission Junction) 4.9 Awin 4.10 Canva Affiliate Program
5. Content	5.1 Written 5.2 Visual 5.3 Video
6. Common challenges	6.1 Picking the right niche 6.2 Getting the right content and captivating copy 6.3 Generating targeted traffic 6.4 Mastering the basic skill of affiliate links 6.5 Sustaining affiliate business
7. Power techniques	7.1 Coupons 7.2 Use pay per click (PPC) advertising 7.3 Start writing reviews on your own affiliate blog 7.4 Leverage email marketing 7.5 Use webinars to promote products

Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning Knowledge	1.1 Concept of affiliate marketing and the common terms used in the process. 1.2 Basic payment models such as pay-per-click, pay-per-sale, and pay-per-lead. 1.3 Key steps involved in starting an affiliate workflow, including linking and tracking. 1.4 Purpose of tracking links, cookies, and conversion data in affiliate activities. 1.5 Basic idea of tools used for affiliate campaigns and how they support promotion. 1.6 Core principles of creating promotional content and placing affiliate links correctly. 1.7 Common challenges in affiliate marketing and basic strategies used to improve conversions and income.
2. Underpinning Skills	2.1 Noting major affiliate platforms and how tracking links and conversions work. 2.2 Integrating affiliate systems with online stores and setting up secure payment methods.

	2.3 Reviewing programs and documenting selections for future use. 2.4 Collecting product information and creating clear, engaging promotional content. 2.5 Placing affiliate links correctly and preparing content for publication. 2.6 Running affiliate campaigns across platforms and monitoring engagement. 2.7 Tracking clicks, conversions, and overall campaign performance. 2.8 Developing income-growth strategies and refining them through ongoing monitoring.
3. Underpinning Attitudes	3.1 Commitment to occupational health and safety 3.2 Promptness in carrying out activities 3.3 Sincerity and honesty to duties 3.4 Environmental concerns 3.5 Eagerness to learn 3.6 Tidiness and timeliness 3.7 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in workplace 3.8 Good relationships with peers, sub-ordinates and seniors in workplace
4. Resource Implications	The Following resources must be provided: 4.1 Workplace (simulated or actual) 4.2 Computer/laptop 4.3 Job specifications and work instructions 4.4 Required learning materials

Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical Aspects of Competency	Assessment must evidence that the candidate: 1.1 explained the concept and process of affiliate marketing. 1.2 identified suitable affiliate programs and products. 1.3 created content for affiliate promotion. 1.4 carried out affiliate marketing activities. 1.5 developed strategies to increase conversion and income.
2. Methods of Assessment	Methods of assessment should include: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical demonstration 2.3 Oral questioning 2.4 Portfolio (optional)
3. Context of Assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or

	simulated work place after completion of the training. 3.2 Assessment should be done by a nationally certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.
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Unit of Competency: APPLY AI TOOLS AND TECHNIQUES IN IT FREELANCING	Nominal Duration: 20 hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-ICT-ITF-07-O
Unit Descriptor: This unit covers the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to apply AI tools and techniques in IT freelancing. It specifically includes the tasks of identifying commonly used AI tools and freelancers, using AI tools for writing, design and data tasks, generating creative content using AI applications, and ensuring ethical and responsible use of AI tools.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Identify commonly used AI tools for freelancers.	1.1 Commonly used <u>AI tools for freelancers</u> are identified and listed. 1.2 Functions and features of each AI tool are reviewed and understood. 1.3 Tools suitable for writing, design, data tasks, and automation are categorized. 1.4 Advantages and limitations of different AI tools are recognized. 1.5 Sources for accessing and using AI tools are identified.
2. Use AI tools for writing, design, and data tasks.	2.1 Writing tasks are completed using AI-generated drafts, edits, or suggestions. 2.2 Design tasks are supported with AI-based image creation or enhancement features. 2.3 AI tools for writing, design, and data tasks are accessed and used as required. 2.4 <u>Data tasks</u> are performed using AI functions. 2.5 Outputs generated by AI tools are reviewed and refined for accuracy.
3. Generate creative content using AI applications.	3.1 <u>Creative content requirements</u> are identified and outlined. 3.2 Generated content is reviewed and refined for clarity and relevance. 3.3 Creative outputs are customized to match project goals and audience needs. 3.4 Final creative content is formatted and saved appropriately. 3.5 Completed content is documented and shared for client

	or project use.
4. Ensure ethical and responsible use of AI tools.	4.1 <u>Ethical guidelines for AI usage</u> are identified and understood. 4.2 AI tools are used responsibly, avoiding harmful or misleading outputs. 4.3 Data privacy and confidentiality requirements are followed during AI use. 4.4 Copyright and intellectual property rules are respected when generating content. 4.5 AI-generated results are reviewed to prevent bias or inaccuracies.

Range of Variables

Variable	Range
	May include but not limited to:
1. AI tools for freelancers	1.1 ChatGPT 1.2 Copilot 1.3 Jasper AI 1.4 Copy.ai 1.5 HubSpot 1.6 AdCreative.ai 1.7 Canva AI 1.8 Adobe Sensei 1.9 SEMrush AI
2. Data tasks	2.1 Cleaning 2.2 Sorting 2.3 Analyzing 2.4 Summarizing
3. Creative content requirements	3.1 Text content 3.2 Images 3.3 Videos 3.4 Audio/voice 3.5 Social media content 3.6 Marketing copy 3.7 Infographics/visual designs
4. Ethical guidelines for AI usage	4.1 Use AI transparently 4.2 Protect user data and privacy 4.3 Avoid generating harmful or misleading content 4.4 Respect copyright and intellectual property 4.5 Check outputs for bias or discrimination 4.6 Verify accuracy before using or sharing 4.7 Use AI within legal and organizational policies

Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning Knowledge	1.1 Common AI tools used by freelancers and their general purposes. 1.2 Key functions and features of AI tools for writing, design,
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	data work, and automation. 1.3 Categories of AI tools based on task type. 1.4 Basic advantages and limitations of using AI tools in freelancing. 1.5 Common sources or platforms where AI tools can be accessed or used. 1.6 General idea of how AI assists in writing, design, and data-related tasks. 1.7 Basic steps in reviewing and refining AI-generated outputs for accuracy and clarity. 1.8 Principles of data privacy, copyright, and avoiding biased or misleading AI outputs.
2. Underpinning Skills	2.1 Categorizing tools for writing, design, data work, and automation. 2.2 Noting advantages, limitations, and access sources for different AI tools. 2.3 Using AI tools to support writing, design, and data-related tasks. 2.4 Reviewing and refining AI-generated outputs for accuracy and quality. 2.5 Creating creative content with AI and customizing it to match project needs. 2.6 Formatting, saving, and sharing AI-generated content for client or project use. 2.7 Following ethical, safe, and responsible practices when using AI tools. 2.8 Protecting privacy, respecting copyrights, and checking outputs for bias or errors.
3. Underpinning Attitudes	3.1 Commitment to occupational health and safety 3.2 Promptness in carrying out activities 3.3 Sincerity and honesty to duties 3.4 Environmental concerns 3.5 Eagerness to learn 3.6 Tidiness and timeliness 3.7 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in workplace 3.8 Good relationships with peers, sub-ordinates and seniors in workplace
4. Resource Implications	The Following resources must be provided: 4.1 Workplace (simulated or actual) 4.2 Computer/laptop 4.3 Job specifications and work instructions 4.4 Required learning materials

Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical Aspects of Competency	Assessment must evidence that the candidate:
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	1.1 identified commonly used AI tools for freelancers. 1.2 used AI tools for writing, design, and data tasks. 1.3 generated creative content using AI applications. 1.4 ensured ethical and responsible use of AI tools.
2. Methods of Assessment	Methods of assessment should include: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical demonstration 2.3 Oral questioning 2.4 Portfolio (optional)
3. Context of Assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training. 3.2 Assessment should be done by a nationally certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.

Unit of Competency: IMPLEMENT FREELANCING BUSINESS ACTIVITIES	Nominal Duration: 30 hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-ICT-ITF-08-O
Unit Descriptor: This unit of competency covers the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to implement freelancing business activities. It specifically includes the tasks of applying basic business online practices, search and bid for jobs on freelancing platforms, communicating and negotiating with clients, performing and delivering assigned work and maintaining records of income and client feedback.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Apply basic business online practices.	1.1 <u>Basic online business requirements</u> are identified and understood. 1.2 Professional online profiles and portfolios are created and maintained. 1.3 Communication with clients is carried out using appropriate online channels. 1.4 Project proposals, quotations, and invoices are prepared and submitted digitally. 1.5 Online payment methods are set up and managed securely. 1.6 Client feedback and reviews are collected and recorded for improvement.
2. Search and bid for jobs on freelancing platforms.	2.1. Freelancing platforms are accessed and explored for suitable job listings. 2.2. Job requirements and client expectations are reviewed carefully. 2.3. Bids or proposals are prepared and submitted according to platform guidelines. 2.4. Submitted bids are tracked and followed up when necessary.
3. Communicate and negotiate with clients.	3.1. Client messages and inquiries are received and responded to promptly. 3.2. Project requirements and expectations are clarified through effective communication. 3.3. Negotiation on pricing, timelines, and deliverables is carried out professionally. 3.4. Agreements and decisions made during communication are documented.
4. Perform and deliver assigned work.	4.1 Assigned project tasks are reviewed and understood clearly. 4.2 Work is performed according to client instructions and

	agreed requirements. 4.3 Quality standards and deadlines are followed throughout the task. 4.4 Completed work is checked for accuracy and completeness before submission. 4.5 Final deliverables are submitted through the appropriate platform or channel. 4.6 Client revisions or requests are addressed promptly.
5. Maintain records of income and client feedback.	5.1 Records of income from completed projects are maintained accurately. 5.2 Client feedback and reviews are collected and documented systematically. 5.3 Financial transactions and payments are tracked for reference and reporting. 5.4 Feedback is analyzed to identify strengths and improvement areas.

Range of Variables

Variable	Range
	May include but not limited to:
1. Basic online business requirements	1.1 Computer or laptop 1.2 Stable internet connection 1.3 Professional email account 1.4 Online payment method 1.5 Digital portfolio 1.6 Online freelancing profile

Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning Knowledge	1.1 Basic requirements for running online freelance work. 1.2 Common online tools used for proposals, quotations, invoicing, and client communication. 1.3 General idea of online payment methods and how they support secure transactions. 1.4 Purpose of client feedback and reviews for improving freelancing performance. 1.5 Basic process of exploring freelancing platforms and understanding job requirements. 1.6 General understanding of delivering work that meets client instructions, deadlines, and quality standards. 1.7 Importance of keeping accurate records of earnings, payments, and client feedback for future work.
2. Underpinning Skills	2.1 Creating and maintaining professional online profiles and portfolios. 2.2 Preparing digital proposals, quotations, invoices, and other business documents.

	2.3 Reviewing job requirements and following up on submitted proposals. 2.4 Communicating clearly with clients and negotiating pricing, timelines, and deliverables. 2.5 Performing assigned work to required standards and meeting deadlines. 2.6 Submitting final deliverables through the correct platform or channel. 2.7 Keeping accurate records of income, transactions, feedback, and reviews. 2.8 Analyzing feedback to improve future performance.
3. Underpinning Attitudes	3.1 Commitment to occupational health and safety 3.2 Promptness in carrying out activities 3.3 Sincerity and honesty to duties 3.4 Environmental concerns 3.5 Eagerness to learn 3.6 Tidiness and timeliness 3.7 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in the workplace 3.8 Good relationships with peers, subordinates and seniors in the workplace
4. Resource Implications	The following resources must be provided: 4.1 Workplace (simulated or actual) 4.2 Computer/laptop 4.3 Learning materials 4.4 Specifications and work instructions

Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical Aspects of Competency	Assessment must evidence that the candidate: 1.1 applied basic business online practices. 1.2 searched and bid for jobs on freelancing platforms. 1.3 communicated and negotiated with clients. 1.4 performed and delivered assigned work. 1.5 maintained records of income and client feedback.
2. Methods of Assessment	Methods of assessment should include: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical demonstration 2.3 Oral questioning 2.4 Portfolio (optional)
3. Context of Assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training. 3.2 Assessment should be done by a nationally certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.

END OF COMPETENCY STANDARD

Workshop/Lab Facility Standard

Course Name:	IT Freelancing
Number of Trainees:	25

Course-wise Training Space (Theoretical Classroom, Workshop/ Lab/ Classroom cum Workshop):

- Classroom – 350 sft (33 sqm)
 - Workshop/ lab – 800 sft (75 sqm)
- OR
- Classroom cum workshop – 1000 sft (93 sqm)

Major Training Equipment and Training Facilities:

Sl. No.	Major Equipment and Training facilities	Required facilities
1.	Computer/Laptop	01
2.	Printer	01
3.	Scanner	01
4.	Computers/Laptop: (Minimum Intel Core i5 processor (8 th Gen), 8GB RAM (16GB preferred), 500GB SSD storage (1TB preferred), High-resolution monitors (19/20-inch minimum, with color accuracy).	25
5.	Projector: High-resolution projector (HD or 4K) for instructor presentations, large screen for the room to ensure visibility for all trainees.	01
6.	Tools: Office application, photo editing software and video editing software	06
7.	Ergonomic chairs and desks	25
8.	Internet connectivity with power back-up	01

The following conditions must be fulfilled –

- The institute shall not use the same facilities for any other projects/organizations offering a similar course.
- The institute must provide sufficient evidence to prove ownership of the proposed training equipment.

The list denotes the minimum training equipment and facility required to effectively conduct training for a specific course. Additionally, the institute must ensure that all other necessary training tools, equipment, and furniture are available to meet the requirement of competency standards (CS) provided by SICIP.

For the operation of training course on IT Freelancing, the institute must ensure the availability of at least 80% of the major training equipment and training facilities (according to the CS) to be eligible for SICIP training delivery. If the score is below 80%, the remaining equipment and facilities need to be installed before the commencement of the training.

The institute will also provide all other hand tools and power tools as per CS for 25 trainees. Also, they will arrange adequate seating arrangement and classroom setup for the 25 trainees.